

Project Management with GanttProject

GanttProject is an open source task and project management tool that can display Gantt charts and PERT. It is available on Windows, Linux and Mac OS. New project leaders or managers will find GanttProject very user friendly, as it will not overwhelm them with numerous scheduling techniques and options, the way MS Project does.



This cross-platform application is written in Java, and in the *sourceforge.net* repository. It has the widely used capabilities of the commercially available MS Project. Going by the Pareto principle that 80 per cent of the time we use just 20 per cent of the features, GanttProject is just sufficient for both new and seasoned project managers.

Not only project managers, but just about anyone can use it for task management. Wherever there is a need to plan tasks performed by different people, and when tasks have dependencies between them, GanttProject is a great choice.

Why use Project Management (PM) tools?

At some workplaces, applications such as Microsoft Excel are used for task tracking and PM! Spreadsheets are not really meant for this. Users find Excel easy to use, as

they can control every cell, and there is nothing 'behind the scenes' for them to understand. However, computing duration, starting and ending dates manually for each task is a sheer waste of time. And even when done, there is no alert when your plan is flawed.

One of the fundamental problems of planning a project in a spreadsheet is that you never know when an engineer (or task owner) is overloaded or not available (vacation). Planning a project without considering the holidays and vacation of individual task owners only leads to trouble, right from the beginning.

PM tools have a lot of advantages when it comes to project planning and tracking. They allow you to get an overview of the project visually, by presenting the schedule as a Gantt chart. This clearly shows the duration of a task,